



# Improving Product Discovery in Zepto

How faster product discovery can unlock higher conversions and basket value in quick commerce

# The Problem

## Core Challenges

- Users struggle to find relevant products in a catalog of 3,000+ SKUs
- Search and browse experience lacks personalization and intelligent recommendations
- High drop-off rate between app open and first product added to cart

## Why It Matters

| For Users                 | For Business                  |
|---------------------------|-------------------------------|
| Frustration finding items | Lost conversion opportunities |
| Time wasted scrolling     | Lower average order value     |
| Unmet grocery needs       | Reduced repeat purchase rate  |

18%

## Browse-to-Cart Conversion

Current rate vs 25-30% industry benchmark

# Where Friction Happens

01

## App Open

Generic welcome experience

02

## Home Screen

Generic banners, no personalization

03

## Browse Categories

Deep navigation requires 3+ taps to reach products

04

## Search/Scroll

Limited autocomplete, no fuzzy matching

05

## Find Product

No smart sorting, irrelevant results

06

## Add to Cart

Finally reaching purchase

📌 Users spend 60%+ of session time in Steps 2-4 (Home → Search → Find), representing the critical friction zone

# Four Critical Pain Points

1

## Weak Search Experience

- No typo tolerance ("tomto" returns zero results)
- No synonyms ("aata" vs "atta" vs "flour")
- Limited autocomplete suggestions

2

## Generic Home Screen

- Same layout for all users regardless of purchase history
- No "buy again" or "frequently purchased" quick access
- Promotional banners dominate prime real estate

3

## Category Overload

- 15+ top-level categories create decision fatigue
- No smart shortcuts based on user behavior
- Popular items buried deep in hierarchy

4

## Missing Contextual Recommendations

- No "customers also bought" suggestions
- No time-based recommendations (morning coffee, evening snacks)
- No location/occasion-aware suggestions

# Four Solution Areas



## Smart Search 2.0

- Implement fuzzy matching and regional language support
- Add visual search for fresh produce
- Show trending searches and personalized suggestions



## Intelligent Category Shortcuts

- AI-powered "Your Essentials" section with top 10 items
- One-tap reorder for last 3 orders
- Smart category surfacing based on user cohort



## Personalized Home Screen

- Dynamic "Buy Again" carousel based on purchase history
- Time-aware quick picks (breakfast at 7 AM, dinner at 6 PM)
- Reduce banner space, increase product visibility



## Contextual Recommendations Engine

- "Complete your cart" suggestions at checkout
- "Pairs well with" recommendations on product pages
- Weekend vs weekday purchase pattern optimization

# Validation Strategy

## A/B Testing Plan

| Experiment         | Control        | Variant              | Duration |
|--------------------|----------------|----------------------|----------|
| Smart Search       | Current search | Fuzzy + autocomplete | 2 weeks  |
| Personalized Home  | Generic home   | Dynamic carousels    | 3 weeks  |
| Category Shortcuts | Standard nav   | AI shortcuts         | 2 weeks  |
| Recommendations    | No recs        | Contextual recs      | 3 weeks  |

- **Qualitative**  
User interviews (n=20) for search pain points
- **Quantitative**  
Heatmaps on home screen interaction
- **Technical**  
Search query analysis (failed searches, zero-result queries)

# Success Metrics

## Primary Metrics

| Metric              | Current | Target |
|---------------------|---------|--------|
| Browse-to-Cart Rate | 18%     | 25%    |
| Search Success Rate | 65%     | 85%    |
| Time-to-First-Add   | 45 sec  | 30 sec |

## Secondary Metrics

| Metric                | Current | Target |
|-----------------------|---------|--------|
| Avg Items per Order   | 8.2     | 10+    |
| Homepage Scroll Depth | 40%     | 60%    |
| 7-day Retention       | 35%     | 42%    |
| Search Abandonment    | 22%     | 12%    |

❏ Guardrail Metrics: Checkout completion rate (should not decrease), App crash rate (should not increase), Customer support tickets related to search



# Expected Business Impact

**+7%**

## Conversion Rate

Improvement in  
browse-to-cart rate

**+₹35**

## Average Order Value

Higher basket value  
from better discovery

**+7%**

## Retention Rate

Lower CAC over time  
from repeat purchases

**Estimated Revenue Impact:** +₹15-20 Cr ARR from improved conversion and basket value



# Key Takeaways



## Discovery is the Biggest Lever

Improving pre-cart experience has higher ROI than checkout optimization



## Personalization > Promotion

Users want relevance, not discounts upfront



## Speed Matters in Quick Commerce

Every second saved in discovery improves conversion



## Search is Underinvested

Most quick commerce apps treat search as an afterthought

# Next Steps



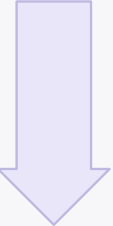
## Prioritize Smart Search

Highest impact, lowest effort implementation



## Build Personalization Pipeline

Establish data infrastructure for recommendations



## Conduct User Research

Design research for category navigation patterns

